

B.T. Franklin

Phoenix, Arizona

Applied AI Technical Lead

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Professional Summary

Applied AI technical lead and software architect with 20+ years of experience across enterprise software, developer tooling, and product-facing systems. Focused on generative AI, LLMs, agentic systems, multimodal AI integrations, AI product architecture, developer tooling, and full-stack AI product execution.

Core Expertise

Applied AI and LLM Systems; Agentic Workflow Design; MCP Server Architecture; RAG, Embeddings, and Semantic Matching; AI Product Architecture; Developer Experience and Platform Tooling; Full-Stack AI Product Engineering; Technical Leadership.

Professional Experience

Zilliant, Inc.

AI Tech Lead / Staff Software Engineer

April 2025 - Present

- Serve as organization-wide AI technical leader, guiding engineering teams on adoption of LLMs, agents, evaluation practices, and modern AI development patterns aligned with business goals.
- Architected the company's first Model Context Protocol (MCP) server, connecting the classic price management stack and formula evaluation service to agent workflows that retrieve calculated prices and explain start, target, and floor price reasoning.
- Drove AI tooling adoption across engineering through Codex workflow training, reusable code-review skills, and agent-assisted development patterns that moved PR review and code-production workflows toward faster turnaround.

Software Architect

August 2022 - March 2025

- Designed and implemented a custom generative AI pipeline that enabled real-time integration of diverse pricing insights into customer-facing analytics experiences.
- Led integration of AWS QuickSight and Amazon Q, embedding analytics visualization and generative AI-assisted question answering into the product UI.

- Served as chief architect for a data access API and designed the Zilliant Developer Experience (ZDX) CLI, reducing complex configuration migration work from a multi-day process to a few hours.

Earlier Zilliant Engineering Roles

January 2009 - August 2022

- Led UI modernization, proof-of-concept development, and cross-team product architecture work across long-running enterprise platform evolution.

Founder-Led and Open Source AI Work

- **RepoZest:** Built and publicly deployed a solo GitHub App-backed repository intelligence SaaS for architecture analysis, contributor expertise modeling, hotspot detection, ownership-fragility signals, and AI-generated repository reports; later sunset and open-sourced as an archived reference project.
- **Hiredar:** Built and deployed a complete solo AI recruiting SaaS in roughly two months, including Stripe Checkout, background workers, resume ingestion, structured extraction, OpenAI API processing, embeddings, Pinecone vector search, RAG-based candidate matching, and recruiter-facing UI.
- **Open source AI tooling:** Created projects including contract4agents, agentic-django, agent-simulator, promptdown, compendiumscribe, release-notes-scribe, pywebview-hmx, and reusable AI agent skills.

Research and Publications

Published computational creativity research in the *Proceedings of Generative Art Conference* and *Proceedings of the 3rd Computer Simulation of Musical Creativity Conference*, covering AI-driven storytelling and generative music systems.

Education

Transylvania University, Lexington, KY: BA in Computer Science, 1997; Minor in Psychology; Graduated with Honors.

Skills

Python; JavaScript/TypeScript; Java; OpenAI GPT, Image Generation, Embeddings, Speech-to-Text, and Interactive Voice; Anthropic Claude; ElevenLabs; Agentic Systems; MCP; RAG; Pinecone; Django; Celery; HTMX; Pydantic; PydanticAI; OpenAI Agents SDK; Codex; Docker; PostgreSQL; SQLite; AWS; QuickSight; Amazon Q; GitHub Actions; Terraform; React; Vue; Tailwind CSS; API Design; Platform Design; Technical Strategy.